



Mercury Premier Dealer

harrisboatworks.ca
905-342-2153

Your New Mercury

OWNER QUICK-START · PAGE 1 OF 2

The first 10 hours and beyond

Welcome, and thanks for buying your new Mercury from a third-generation family marina. Since 1947 we have rigged, launched, and serviced outboards right here on Rice Lake, and we want your first season to go smoothly. The first few hours on a new engine matter. Use this guide as a practical starting point for break-in, early service, and long-term care. We have your motor details on file, so when you call or book we can match the exact manual for your motor.

YOUR MANUAL WINS

Break-in RPM, oil, battery, storage position, gearcase, and warranty terms are specific to your motor's serial number and can't be generalized across 2.5–300 hp. If this sheet and your manual ever disagree, follow the manual.

THE FIRST 10 HOURS · BREAK-IN BY HORSEPOWER

Vary throttle often, avoid holding one RPM, and make throttle changes gradually. RPM ceilings differ by horsepower range, so confirm yours in the manual.

2.5 – 20 hp

Portable FourStroke

HOURL 1

Vary throttle up to 2000 rpm (about half throttle).

HOURL 2

Vary up to 3000 rpm (about three-quarter throttle). Where the manual allows, about one minute at full throttle every 10 minutes.

NEXT 8 HRS

Avoid continuous full throttle for more than five minutes.

25 – 60 hp

Mid-range FourStroke

HOURL 1

Vary throttle up to 3500 rpm (about half throttle).

HOURL 2

Vary up to 4500 rpm (about three-quarter throttle). Where the manual allows, about one minute at full throttle every 10 minutes.

NEXT 8 HRS

Avoid continuous full throttle for more than five minutes.

75 – 300 hp

V6 / V8 / Pro XS / Verado

FIRST 2 HRS

Vary throttle up to 4500 rpm (about three-quarter throttle). Where the manual allows, about one minute at full throttle every 10 minutes.

NEXT 8 HRS

Avoid continuous full throttle for more than five minutes.

NOTE

Higher-hp families vary by model; use your serial-specific manual.

UNIVERSAL DO / AVOID

DO

- ✓ Vary engine speed and RPM often.
- ✓ Make throttle changes gradually.
- ✓ Use only the full-throttle bursts your manual allows.
- ✓ Not sure? Call us before you run it hard.

AVOID

- ✗ Do not hold one steady RPM for long stretches.
- ✗ Do not run sustained wide-open throttle during break-in.
- ✗ Do not heavily load or idle the engine for long while new.
- ✗ Do not assume one RPM table fits every horsepower.

HBW DEALER BEST PRACTICE

At about 20 hours

HBW recommends booking an early oil-and-filter service at about 20 hours. This removes the break-in material that collects in the first oil and gives your new Mercury a clean start.

This early service is HBW dealer best practice. Most current Mercury FourStroke manuals then schedule maintenance at 100 hours or once a year, whichever comes first. Follow your manual after this first service.

Book your 20-hour service early. We already have your motor details on file.



Care, fuel, and coverage

Fuel and oil

- Use clean, fresh fuel that meets the octane rating in your manual.
- Most Canadian manuals list 87 (R+M)/2 as the minimum octane; premium is usually fine too. Check your manual to confirm.
- Engine fuel systems tolerate up to 10% ethanol (E10), but your boat's fuel and storage system may not. Ethanol can raise corrosion and phase-separation risk.
- Use NMMA FC-W certified marine four-stroke oil in the viscosity your engine specifies.
- Do not use automotive oil or two-stroke TC-W3 oil in a Mercury FourStroke.

100 hours or annually

After your first service, follow your Mercury manual, typically service every 100 hours or once a year, whichever comes first. Typical tasks:

- Change engine oil and filter where equipped; change gearcase lubricant.
- Inspect fuel filters, anodes, propeller, and fastener tightness.
- Inspect battery; lubricate the propeller shaft.
- Flush cooling system after use in salt, muddy, or polluted water.

Longer-interval tasks (impeller, spark plugs, trim fluid) follow your manual's 300-hour or three-year schedule.

Ontario winterization and storage

Ontario storage is hard on engines put away wet, untreated, or with old fuel. Book fall service before sustained overnight temperatures fall below 0°C. Thanksgiving weekend is a practical target. General steps, per your manual:

- Stabilize or manage fuel as directed; run treated fuel through the engine.
- Change engine oil; drain and refill gearcase lubricant.
- Protect internal cylinders and inspect anodes where specified.
- Service and store the battery; store the engine so trapped water can drain.

Storage position varies: some portables allow specific horizontal positions; larger engines store vertical and full down. Confirm your model.

Warranty and records

- Your dealer registers your new Mercury with Mercury Marine at the time of sale, and registration is required for coverage.
- Keep registration, service records, oil receipts, and winterization records; Mercury can tie coverage to proof of proper maintenance.
- Warranty length and corrosion coverage are set by Mercury and vary by model, use, and current terms. Ask us for the terms on your engine.
- Corrosion coverage requires proper registration, authorized-dealer purchase, and timely maintenance such as anode replacement.

Mercury Product Protection

- Most engines can add Mercury Product Protection while still under factory warranty. Eligibility depends on model, age, and hours; we verify it with your serial number.
- Platinum is the name of the highest Product Protection coverage tier, and it is the only tier we sell. (Coverage tier name only; our dealer status is Mercury Premier Dealer.)
- Manufacturer-backed parts and labour, honoured at authorized Mercury dealers.
- Covers major mechanical and electrical components and eligible controls; exact terms are set by Mercury.
- Transferable per Mercury's process and terms.

HBW OWNER OFFER

The best time to add coverage is while your factory warranty is active.

HBW takes 10% off Mercury's current rates on eligible Mercury Product Protection plans. Ask us to confirm eligibility and current terms.

See coverage details: harrisboatworks.ca/warranty

Questions? We can help.

We have your motor details on file, so we can confirm the correct Mercury manual and service schedule for your motor.

BOOK	hbw.wiki/service
CALL	(905) 342-2153
TEXT	(647) 952-2153
VISIT	5369 Harris Boat Works Rd, Gores Landing, ON K0K 2E0
ONLINE	harrisboatworks.ca

BEFORE EVERY OUTING

Quick pre-launch check

A one-minute walkaround before you leave the dock.

- ✓ Oil level in range
- ✓ Lanyard stop switch works
- ✓ No fuel leaks or fuel smell
- ✓ Engine mount secure
- ✓ Steering moves freely
- ✓ Propeller not bent or loose
- ✓ Cooling-water intake clear
- ✓ Battery terminals tight